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INSTITUTE FOR COMMUNITY INCLUSION, UMASS BOSTON

Using National Data to Understand and Prepare Students With Intellectual Disability for Inclusive Higher Education

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Federally funded since 2010 to coordinate data collection with TPSID projects and to provide training and technical assistance to colleges, universities, students, families, transition professionals and K-12 educators who are interested in postsecondary education opportunities for students with intellectual disability.

www.thinkcollege.net

College
options for
people with
intellectual
disability



ThinkCollege
CHANGING EXPECTATIONS. INCREASING OPPORTUNITIES.

🔍 COLLEGE SEARCH

📖 RESOURCE LIBRARY

⇄ INNOVATION EXCHANGE

📖 WHAT'S HAPPENING IN YOUR STATE

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Transition Postsecondary Programs for Students with Intellectual Disability (TPSID)

Goal: to create, expand, or enhance high-quality, inclusive higher education experiences to support positive outcomes for individuals with ID.



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TPSIDs represent about 1/3 of higher education programs for students with ID in the US



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College Experiences



ACADEMICS



CAMPUS LIFE



CAREER
DEVELOPMENT



EMPLOYMENT



CREDENTIAL
ATTAINMENT



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TPSID Data 2019-2020

Academics



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In 2019-2020

936 students



enrolled in

6,750 courses



for an average of

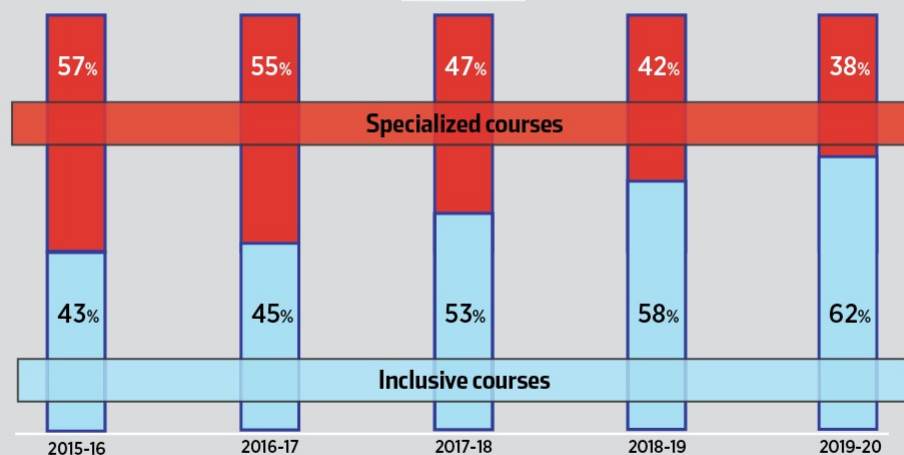
7 courses (inclusive or specialized)
per student per year.

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COURSE ACCESS

Inclusive vs. specialized course enrollments

COHORT 2



TPSID Cohort Trend Data (2015–2020)

Changing Expectations. Increasing Opportunities.

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Examples of Inclusive Courses

An Introduction to the University	Criminal Law	Encounters in Human Diversity	Fundamentals of Food Preparation	Fundamentals of Public Speaking	General Psychology
Graphic Design I	Intermediate Algebra	Introduction to Sociology	Introduction to Acting	Introduction to Sculpture Studio	Math 101
Micro-computing Systems	Office Skills I	Principles of Marketing	Race and Social Justice	Strategies for Success in College	U.S. History Since 1877

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Academic preparation

College expectation	Secondary preparation
Communicating with instructor	Discussing accommodations with teachers; discussing support; communication with teacher(e.g., absence, running late, set up meeting)
Following a syllabus	Reading and following a high school syllabus
Being prepared for class	Following checklist to complete prep: readings, notes, anticipated topics for discussion
Taking notes	Practice using Smartpen (e.g., Livescribe), following and summarizing class discussions
Working with a classmate	Complete class projects with a partner; work in groups
Using learning management system (e.g. Blackboard, eLearning, PLATO)	Practice navigating with free tool such as Schoology

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Managing academic responsibilities

- Break long-term assignments into short term goals
- Maintain a weekly study schedule
- Modify the schedule as needed
- Identify strategies for advocating for assistance when a challenging academic situation arises



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Explore local options

- Sign up for a evening or weekend class in your community
- Topic of INTEREST -Not Academic
- Local, low cost, low risk
- Identify
 - Instructional setting preferences
 - Learning and behavioral support needs
 - Time management issues
 - Assess motivation and future interest



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Residential Options and Supports



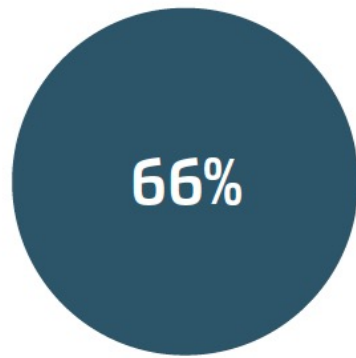
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Of the 41 TPSID programs located at residential schools, 27 (66%) offered housing and 14 did not.



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Student place of residence



Lived with family



Lived in IHE
housing



Lived in non-IHE
housing, not
with family

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Most common residential supports



Residential assistant or advisor (20/27 programs)



Intermittent or on-call support staff (13/27 programs)



Uncompensated roommate/suitemate (6/27 programs)

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College Life Participation

College expectation	Secondary preparation
Using technology to manage schedule	Build in opportunities for students to develop their own weekly schedule, make and record appts
Campus engagement: fitness center	Support students to build in fitness and sports as preferred and with a partner
Campus engagement: clubs	Support students to explore interests in high school or community clubs
Campus engagement: socializing/campus events	Assist students to engage in inclusive social activities in and out of school



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The Importance of Smart Phones



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ALL students need to know how to:

- Make a phone call
- Charge their phone
- Add a contact
- Make a note
- Get directions to walk somewhere
- Use a search engine to answer a question
- Set up a calendar
- Create deadlines and reminders
- Create favorite contacts
- Send a text
- Send a picture



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What can teachers do

- provide opportunities for responsible use of mobile devices in the classroom.
- encourage use of reminder apps that send text messages about assignment due dates,
- help students review course content for upcoming exams using apps
- help students record class lectures and retrieve and use recordings for notes or studying



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More ideas to support success

01

Talk with student and family about responsibilities at home

02

Help student set personal goals related to managing their schedule and activities

03

Consider options for staying overnight away from family for short periods of time

04

Explore summer programs for exposure to college without the commitment



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Career Development and Employment



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Career awareness and exploration

In 2019–2020 most students enrolled in TPSIDs (n = 812, 85%) participated in at least one CAE activity.

TABLE 3. PARTICIPATION IN CAE ACTIVITIES IN 2019-2020

	Number of students who participated in activity (N=956*)	Percentage of students who participated in activity
Create or revise resume	752	79%
Interest inventory	615	64%
Mock interview	564	59%
Gathered references	504	53%
Labor market research	483	51%
Career fair	391	41%
Informational interview	367	38%
Company tour	333	35%
Job shadow	279	29%
Create LinkedIn profile	192	20%
Other activity	197	21%

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Paid work-based learning

- Paid WBL experiences included internships, student enterprises, and work training experiences.
- One hundred sixty-three students (17%) had at least one paid WBL experience.
- These students had a total of 327 paid WBL experiences. Ninety-seven students had multiple paid WBL experiences during the year.



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Work-based learning pay rates

66% (n = 208) paid at or above the federal minimum wage of \$7.25 per hour

34% (n=108) paid below minimum wage



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Unpaid work-based learning

42% of TPSID students (n = 401 students) participated in 652 unpaid WBL experiences.

Included:

- 407 unpaid internships (62%)
- 141 unpaid work experiences (22%)
- 45 service-learning experiences (7%)



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Paid employment

- 305 students (32%) were engaged in any type of paid employment while enrolled.
- 85 students (28%) had more than one paid employment

417 paid employment positions were held by students.




44% of students (n = 419) had at least one paid position while enrolled.

"Paid positions" combines data on paid employment and paid work-based learning

56% of employed students enrolled in the TPSID programs had never held a paid job prior to entering the TPSID.



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Strategies to Support Success in College

01

Focus on career exploration and document students' experiences and preferences

02

Don't waste time on job preparation activities where students are not actively learning

03

Provide students with paid employment experiences

04

Help students create a resume and practice discussing their skills and interests

05

Provide support for job searches, filling out job applications, and practice interviewing skills



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Credential attainment IHE Approval



Students were able to earn a credential at all 58 programs



Thirty-three programs (57%) offered a TPSID-specific credential that was approved by the IHE.



Eight programs offered a credential that aligned with an existing labor market credential.



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**Of the students who exited, 79%
(n = 270) completed a program and
earned a credential.**

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Lessons learned

01

When conducting a college search consider what outcomes are desired by student

02

Accumulating credits toward a credential may impact future learning options

03

Explore interest in job specific credentials available in local community colleges



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Our Professional Capacity

- Do we know all current college options?
- Do we share it with parents/students in a meaningful way?
- Are ALL students included in college search and preparation activities?
- Do ALL students with disability get access to the HS counselor?



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Ensure College is evident in IEP

Measurable postsecondary goal: Education and training

After graduation, Juan will attend a college or university to pursue education in support of his chosen career path.

IEP goals

Using online resources, Juan will identify a minimum of 3 potential careers that match his interests and strengths, and will be able to state the educational requirements for those careers.

Transition services and activities

- Self-advocacy skills instruction
- Research and visit colleges and universities that have programs in areas that match potential careers
- Attend college fair
- Participate in extra-curricular activities
- Provide information on financial support for college
- Make a plan for paying for college



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Consider who gets access to information

Transition Fair

- Community Rehabilitation Providers
- Employment Supports
- Social service agencies
- Vocational Rehabilitation
- Special education staff
- Transition Staff

College Fair

- Community colleges
- Universities
- Career and technical colleges
- Certificate programs
- For profit universities
- Online colleges
- Financial Aid info Sessions

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It is not only possible, it is HAPPENING!!

- Over 6000 students with ID are enrolled in college right now
- Most are taking college courses and many are earning credits
- Many are employed for pay while enrolled
- Most are earning credentials that lead to future jobs



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With intention and preparation students with ID can go to college.



Your beliefs and expectations have a *greater* impact on a student going to college than that student's skills or disability



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Expect that students with intellectual disability will:

- Learn after they leave high school
- Have some non-traditional college goals
- Be dissatisfied when they have a crummy job
- Grow and change in their desires and skills
- Believe what you say about their potential



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The POWER of EXPECTATIONS



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The banner features the ThinkCollege logo at the top, which includes a stylized building icon and the text "ThinkCollege". Below the logo is the tagline "CHANGING EXPECTATIONS. INCREASING OPPORTUNITIES." in white text on an orange background. The main body of the banner is white and contains the following text: "TO LEARN MORE" in green, "www.thinkcollege.net" in blue, "NEED ADVICE?" in green, and "thinkcollegeTA@gmail.com" in blue. At the bottom, there is a blue bar containing the Facebook and Twitter logos and their respective URLs: "www.facebook.com/thinkcollege" and "www.twitter.com/thinkcollegeici".

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